

SQL String Functions

A quick reference guide for common string manipulation operations

LENGTH () / CHAR_LENGTH ()

LENGTH (str)

Returns the length of a string in bytes or characters.

```
SELECT id, full_name,  
LENGTH(full_name) AS name_length FROM strT;
```

CONCAT ()

CONCAT (s1, s2, ...)

Joins two or more strings together sequentially.

```
SELECT id, full_name, job_title,  
CONCAT(full_name, ' - ', job_title) AS name_with_job  
FROM str;
```

CONCAT_WS ()

CONCAT_WS (separator, s1, ...)

Concatenates with a specified separator character defined first.

```
SELECT id, full_name, city, job_title,  
CONCAT_WS(' | ', full_name, city, job_title) AS combined_info  
FROM str;
```

UPPER() / LOWER()

UPPER(str) / LOWER(str)

Transforms text casing to absolute uppercase or lowercase.

```
SELECT id, UPPER(full_name) AS upper_name,  
       LOWER(full_name) AS lower_name  
FROM strt;
```

LEFT() / RIGHT()

LEFT(str, len)

Extracts a set number of characters starting from either edge.

```
SELECT id,  
       LEFT(full_name, 3) AS left_part,  
       RIGHT(full_name, 4) AS right_part  
FROM strT;
```

TRIM() / LTRIM() / RTRIM()

TRIM(str)

Strips leading and trailing whitespace padding from text.

```
SELECT id,  
       TRIM(full_name) AS trimmed,  
       LTRIM(full_name) AS left_trimmed,  
       RTRIM(full_name) AS right_trimmed  
FROM strT;
```

SUBSTRING()

SUBSTRING(str, pos, len)

Extracts a specific slice of text from anywhere inside the string.

```
SELECT id, full_name,  
       SUBSTRING(full_name, 1, 5) AS sub_name  
FROM strT;
```

Locating Substrings (Cross-Platform)

[Find Index](#)

Locates the starting character position index of a search string inside a target string.

MYSQL

```
SELECT INSTR(email, '@')  
FROM employees;
```

SQL SERVER

```
SELECT CHARINDEX('@', email)  
FROM employees;
```

POSTGRESQL

```
SELECT POSITION('@' IN email)  
FROM employees;
```